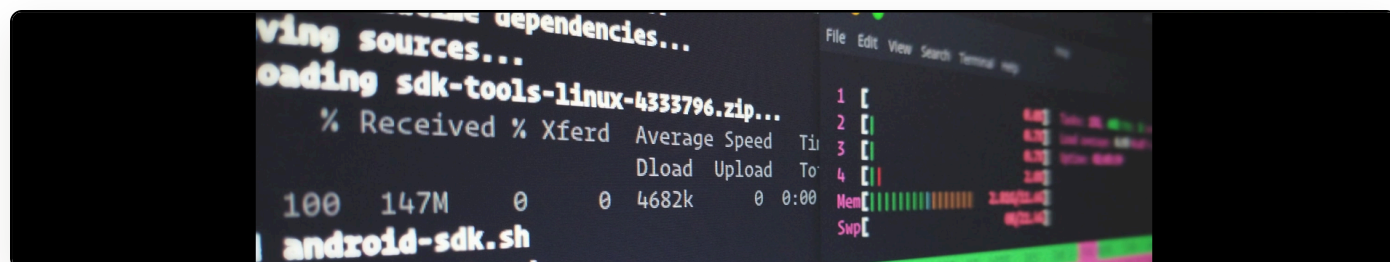


Enabling a triple-head (3 monitor) setup on Linux Mint 16 ("Petra") with two Nvidia cards

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OK, so this was utterly painful and I needed to share what finally worked for me. I have 2 x Nvidia GTX480 cards. I have 3 x monitors. I wanted to be able to run all three off the same box, using it as a single X Screen (i.e. so I can move windows between screens and it acts correctly). No matter what I tried, it wouldn't let me do so with the proprietary driver. I [asked on Stack Exchange](#) and got somewhere closer. Here's what worked:

- Use driver 319.60 or 337.12. 331.20 did *not* work for me.

Update (28th August 2015): I've now had success with driver 346, so this tutorial is still relevant.

- Install the SLI bridge (hardware). Even though you are not using SLI, you need to put the bridge in and enable it.
- Use SLIMosaic and BaseMosaic options. *Ignore the fact the manual implies it won't work for this card. It does.*

My XConfig looks like this:

Section "ServerLayout"

Identifier "Layout0"
Screen 0 "Screen0"

EndSection

Section "Monitor"

HorizSync source: edid, VertRefresh source: edid

Identifier "Monitor1"
VendorName "Unknown"
ModelName "Ancor Communications Inc ASUS VS247"
HorizSync 24.0 - 83.0
VertRefresh 50.0 - 75.0
Option "DPMS"

EndSection

Section "Monitor"

HorizSync source: edid, VertRefresh source: edid

Identifier "Monitor0"
VendorName "Unknown"
ModelName "LG Electronics W2243"
HorizSync 30.0 - 83.0
VertRefresh 56.0 - 75.0
Option "DPMS"

EndSection

Section "Monitor"

HorizSync source: unknown, VertRefresh source: unknown

Identifier "Monitor2"
VendorName "Unknown"
ModelName "AOC LM720/LM720A"
HorizSync 30.0 - 83.0
VertRefresh 55.0 - 75.0
Option "DPMS"

EndSection

Section "Device"

Identifier "Device1"
Driver "nvidia"
VendorName "NVIDIA Corporation"
BoardName "GeForce GTX 480"
BusID "PCI:1:0:0"

EndSection

Section "Device"

```

Identifier      "Device0"
Driver          "nvidia"
VendorName      "NVIDIA Corporation"
BoardName       "GeForce GTX 480"
BusID           "PCI:1:0:0"
EndSection

Section "Screen"
    Identifier   "Screen0"
    Device       "Device0"
    Monitor      "Monitor0"
    DefaultDepth 24
    Option       "Stereo" "0"
    Option       "MultiGPU" "Off"
    Option       "SLI" "on"
    Option       "SLIMosaic" "True"
    Option       "BaseMosaic" "True"
    Option       "MetaModes" "GPU-1.CRT-0: 1280x1024+0+0, GPU-0.CRT-0:
1920x1080+1280+0, GPU-0.DFP-2: 1920x1080+3200+0"
    SubSection   "Display"
        Depth    24
    EndSubSection
EndSection

```

Totally weirdly, you don't need to have more than one device listed (my second card is at "PCI:1:0:0").

Note also that, despite this then yielding two providers, when it's working xrandr 1.4 (which supports multiple GPUs) only lists 1 provider:

```

xrandr --listproviders
Providers: number : 1
Provider 0: id: 0x279 cap: 0x1, Source Output crtcs: 4 outputs: 10 associated
providers: 0 name:NVIDIA-0"

```

Anyway, it now works!